

• Marl

Ruiz team miniworkshop

AVAILABLE NODES — DRAG FROM HERE

 Gmail — Send Email

 Google Sheets — Log Request

 Set Node — Prepare Data

 Form Trigger

 Google Drive — Create Folder

YOUR WORKFLOW — DROP NODES IN ORDER

1  Form Trigger

2  Google Sheets — Log Request

3  Google Drive — Create Folder

4  Set Node — Prepare Data

5  Gmail — Send Email

✓ Check My Order

✓ All 5 nodes in the correct order! The workflow flows exactly as the group built it: Form Trigger → Google Sheets → Google Drive → Set Node → Gmail.

QUESTION 1 OF 5

In the DSS pipeline, which component does n8n belong to?

- ☐ A Knowledge Base — it permanently stores all student records
- ☒ B Software System — it processes and routes data between components
- ☐ C User Interface — students interact with n8n directly
- ☐ D Decision Model — n8n makes final decisions for the Registrar

✓ **Correct — B.** From Slide 5: "n8n sits in the Software System layer — it processes and routes data between components." The Software System layer handles the automation logic; it doesn't store data permanently (Knowledge Base) nor is it what users interact with visually (User Interface).

QUESTION 2 OF 5

Before automation, how long did the full manual process take — folder creation, file organization, and sending confirmation?

- ☐ A 5 minutes total
- ☒ B 7 minutes total
- ☐ C 10 minutes total
- ☐ D 20 minutes total

✓ **Correct — C.** From Slide 6: Folder Creation (2 min) + File Organization (5 min) + Sending Confirmation (3 min) = **10 minutes total**. With n8n, this now takes approximately **~3 seconds** — that's a 200× speed improvement.

QUESTION 3 OF 5

Which of the following best describes what **triggers** the n8n workflow in this system?

- ☐ A A Registrar staff member manually pressing a button each time
- ☒ B A student submitting a Google Form (also supports Sheet updates & scheduled triggers)
- ☐ C An email received by the Registrar's inbox
- ☐ D A nightly batch job that runs every 24 hours

✓ **Correct** — B. From Slide 4, the listed inputs are: Google Form submit, Google Sheet updates, and Scheduled Trigger. The primary trigger demonstrated is the Google Form submission — when a student sends a request, n8n activates immediately and automatically.

QUESTION 4 OF 5

Which of the following is **NOT** listed as an output of the n8n workflow in this presentation?

- ☐ A Email alert sent to the Registrar staff
- ☐ B A row appended to Google Sheets (request log)
- ☒ C A PDF document automatically generated and printed
- ☐ D A Google Drive folder created for the student's files

✓ **Correct** — C. From Slide 4, the three outputs are: Email alert to *adviser*, Sheet row updated, and Folder created in Google Drive. PDF generation and printing is never mentioned — n8n handles digital automation only. Always read outputs carefully; it's easy to assume a system does more than it actually does.

QUESTION 5 OF 5

The group's conclusion (Slide 6) states this system "serves as a foundational DSS." What does this mean?

- ☐ A It replaces the Registrar completely — no human staff are needed
- ☐ B It is only a prototype and will never be used in production
- ☒ C It enhances efficiency and supports decision-making, but humans still make final decisions
- ☐ D It stores all university data in a central database

✓ **Correct** — C. The slide quotes: "This system enhances operational efficiency, accountability, and student satisfaction." A DSS supports decisions — it doesn't replace human judgment. The Registrar still reviews requests and releases documents; n8n just removes the slow, repetitive manual steps so staff can focus on decisions that actually require a person.

4/5

QUIZ SCORE

Perfect score! You really paid attention.

○ YOUR N8N WORKFLOW CANVAS – FILL IN EACH NODE

1

TRIGGER – WHAT STARTS THE WORKFLOW?

A Google Sheet is updated when Registrar staff marks a student's document status as Ready.

2

NODE 2 – WHAT DOES N8N READ OR CHECK FIRST?

n8n reads the specific row to extract the student's name, email address, and the type of document that is ready.

3

NODE 3 – WHAT PROCESSING OR FORMATTING HAPPENS?

A Set node or Template node generates a personalized email subject line and body using the student's name and document details.

4

OUTPUT – WHAT IS THE FINAL RESULT OF THE WORKFLOW?

An email is automatically sent to the student stating: 'Hello [Name], your [Document] is ready for pickup at the Registrar's Office.'

🔥 REFLECTION QUESTION

In 2–3 sentences: How does the workflow you designed support decision-making in the Registrar's Office? Who benefits, and how is it better than the manual process?

This workflow supports decision-making by automating the repetitive ETL tasks of folder creation and data routing, allowing Registrar staff to focus on approving student records rather than manual administration. Both students and staff benefit from the 200x speed improvement, which eliminates the 10-minute manual

Node / Tool	Node Type	What it does in this system
 Google Form Trigger	Trigger	Starts the entire workflow the moment a student submits a document request form. ✓ (example)
 Google Sheets	Action	Appends a new row to the master request log to tract every studer
 Google Drive	Action	Automatically creates a dedicated student folder and organizes up
 Set Node	Transform	Extracts and formats variables like the student's name and docum
 Gmail (×2 branches)	Output	Sends a confirmation email to the student and a notification alert

🔍 ANSWER KEY – REVEAL AFTER YOU FINISH

▼ Google Sheets – what does it do?

Appends a new row to the **Request Log sheet** with all the student's request details. This is what the presentation calls "**Centralized Data Logging**" — all requests are stored in one place so the Registrar has a complete record.

▼ Google Drive – what does it do?

Creates a **named folder** in the Registrar's Google Drive specifically for that student's document files. From Slide 6: this replaced a **2-minute manual task** and now happens **instantly**.

▼ Set Node – what does it do?

Formats the data before the email is sent — it sets the **email subject line, body text, and recipient address** using values pulled from the form submission. Think of it as a mail-merge step that assembles the message.

▼ Gmail (×2 branches) – what does it do?

Sends **two separate emails simultaneously**: (1) a **confirmation email to the student** acknowledging their request, and (2) a **notification to Registrar staff** that a new request has arrived. From Slide 6: this replaced a **3-minute manual task** and now happens **instantly**.

"I answered it differently than the final answer, but I believe mine was still correct."

Narrative Report: USTP-CDO Registrar Automation Project

Overview

This project transformed the USTP-CDO student intake process from a slow, manual chore into a high-speed automated pipeline. By using **n8n** to link Google Workspace with a **PostgreSQL** database, we replaced a 10-minute administrative "bottleneck" with a workflow that finishes in just 3 seconds.

Challenges & Solutions

- **The "Glue" Problem:** Getting different platforms (Google Forms, Sheets, and Drive) to talk to n8n reliably was the first hurdle. We solved this by refining our webhook triggers and using **Set Nodes** to ensure data stayed clean as it moved through the system.
- **Scaling Up:** Moving from a simple spreadsheet to a hosted **PostgreSQL** database on Render was a technical jump. We adjusted our "Load" scripts to handle cloud connections, ensuring the system was a robust tool rather than just a local prototype.

Key Insights

- **Efficiency at Scale: Seeing a 200x speed improvement** was a wake-up call. It proved that automation isn't just about speed; it's about removing the "busy work" so staff can focus on students.
- **Support, Not Replacement:** We learned that a **Decision Support System (DSS)** doesn't replace people. It acts as a foundation that eliminates human error (like misfiled folders) and gives the Registrar staff better data to work with.
- **Seamless Integration:** The project highlighted how tools like Python and n8n can turn a messy manual process into a professional, "hands-off" digital experience.

Conclusion

This activity demonstrated that digital transformation is a necessity, not a luxury. We successfully built a foundational system that ensures student records are processed accurately and instantly, setting a high standard for future administrative automation.